Responsible Administrator: VP Univ Advancement
Responsible Office: University Advancement
Effective Date: August 2025
Approved by: President

Naming Policy

Policy Statement

Facilities and programs at Southeastern Louisiana University may be named to recognize individuals or entities who have made significant contributions to the University. All naming proposals must be recommended by the University President and approved by the University of Louisiana System Board of Supervisors. No facility or program may be named, nor a naming commitment made, prior to full approval.

Naming may honor individuals (including living persons), organizations, or private entities. Functional naming (e.g., "Band Building") and term-limited corporate sponsorship naming may be authorized at the discretion of the University President.

Current public officials, candidates for public office, and current members of the Board of Supervisors are not eligible for naming recognition. All naming must reflect positively on the University's values, mission, and reputation.

Purpose of Policy

This policy defines the criteria, procedures, and approval process for naming or renaming facilities and programs. It ensures alignment with University values and compliance with applicable laws and University of Louisiana System policies.

Applicability

This policy applies to all facilities and programs owned, operated, or controlled by Southeastern Louisiana University.

Policy Procedure

Definitions

***Facilities**: Includes buildings, rooms, interior spaces, exterior areas, streets, athletic fields, and other tangible, permanent features under the control of Southeastern Louisiana University (Southeastern).*

***Programs**: Includes colleges, departments, institutes, centers, and other academic or administrative units.*

***Notable Donor or Benefactor:** a memorial gift, a living or deceased individual, a corporation, or other organization whose naming desires may be considered if the gift or donation meets or exceeds an approved amount or normal thresholds (see Section I.F and I.G below for additional stipulations and Section VI for restrictions) or, in individual cases of unusual character, some other threshold approved in advance by the President.*

***Honorific Naming**: Recognizes individuals for exceptional non-monetary contributions or academic distinction.*

***Philanthropic Naming**: Recognizes individuals or entities in return for significant financial contributions.*

***Corporate Sponsorship Naming**: This policy provides for the recognition of private entities through term-limited agreements with significant financial contributions. It applies specifically to facility and program naming rights associated with major sponsorships. Sponsorships related to Athletics are generally excluded; however, any Athletic*

Sponsorship that involves a facility name recognition must still adhere to the guidelines as established in Section II.F.iii. and Section III. Such major sponsorships will be coordinated with the VPUA and approved by the President.

I. General Policy

A. The Facilities and Programs under the control of Southeastern are named upon the recommendation of the President with the approval and authority of the Board of Supervisors, in accordance with applicable statutes and regulations and this Policy.

B. The act of naming a facility or program shall be that of the President, after receiving the Naming Advisory Committee's recommendation from the Vice President for University Advancement.

C. The Naming Advisory Committee shall consist of the following members:
   a. CHAIR: Vice President for University Advancement
   b. Director of Facility Planning
   c. Lead development officer responsible for securing gift
   d. Relevant Dean (if applicable)
   e. Athletics Director (if applicable)
   f. VP for Administration & Finance or designee (as needed)
   g. Provost/VP for Academic Affairs or designee (as needed)

D. In order to honor donors, substantial contributions to the University must be in accordance with pre-approved minimums that are maintained in the Office of University Advancement and within the guidelines for naming of facilities and programs. Exceptions require University President approval and University of Louisiana System Board of Supervisors authorization.

E. Any proposal, gift, pledge or planned giving agreement that contemplates delivery of a naming to a donor must contain the following language:

> *Any and all namings involving buildings or portions thereof, sites, streets, open spaces, colleges, schools, departments, institutes, programs or centers under the control of the Board of Supervisors of Southeastern Louisiana University require the approval of the Dean and/or Vice President/Provost or comparable administrative officer under whose immediate authority the Facility or Program falls, the Vice President for University Advancement, the President, and the Board of Supervisors and must be in compliance with State law and Southeastern's Naming Policy. No naming or agreed alternative naming may be delivered to any person, organization or corporation without said approval nor will any alleged promise be honored that does not comply with these stipulations. Donors are advised that approval is not automatic or guaranteed.*

F. Minimum* Facility Contributions:
   - Public/private projects: 1/3 of project cost or 50% of fundraising goal and 15% of the total gift for facility maintenance and operations endowment
   - Privately funded project: 50% of total project cost
   - Renovation projects: 75% of total project cost
   - Minimum $1 million donation for existing building naming; in all cases the related University unit will be allocated some portion of the funding for an endowment. The amount of the endowment will be determined by the VPUA, Provost and President.

G. Program Contributions Minimum* Endowment:
   - College or Division: not less than $5,000,000
   - Department/ University-wide Center/Institute: not less than $2,000,000
   - Unit/Center/Institute within a College: not less than $1,000,000

H. Select irrevocable deferred gifts may be used if their present value meets naming thresholds and funds are not needed immediately. Prior approval by the VPUA of such gifts is required before submitting to the Naming Advisory Committee.

I. When multiple naming opportunities exist, the responsible University executive and lead development officer must consult with the Vice President for University Advancement (VPUA) before finalizing naming options and gift levels.

**The VPUA may request changes to these minimums on a case-by-case basis, and the University President has the authority to approve such changes as deemed appropriate based on University priorities and needs.*

II. **Procedures**

A. A request to name (or to change the name) of any University Facility or Program must be made in writing to the VPUA. Requests originating from university faculty or staff should be forwarded through established channels. The request should be accompanied by supporting documentation adequate to indicate that the request meets the established criteria outlined in Section F. The VPUA will forward the request, with documentation, to the Naming Advisory Committee (NAC).

B. The NAC will gather such additional information as it may deem appropriate, including soliciting input of any units occupying the Facility in question.

C. The VPUA will take the NAC's recommendation under advisement and will forward the request with her/his recommendation to the President, who will forward it to the Board of Supervisors for approval.

D. The President may reject the recommendation or refer the matter back with request that the NAC reconsider its recommendation. The President may also make a recommendation to the Board of Supervisors at his/her discretion.

E. The VPUA will advise the originator of the request, as well as any other individuals who have indicated their interest in the matter in writing, of the final decision of the request.

F. Criteria

i. In the case of purely functional names, in which the name of an individual person, organization or corporation is not involved, the President may make this decision or he/she may call upon the NAC to consider the appropriateness and accuracy of the name, its simplicity for utilitarian purposes, and the extent to which it duplicates or approximates the names of other campus facilities.

ii. In the case of requests to name Facilities or Programs in honor of an individual, the NAC will be guided by the following criteria. An individual for whom a Facility or Program would be named should:

1. have had some significant connection with the university, either as a student, an alumnus, a faculty member, an administrator, a Notable Donor or Benefactor, or a supporter and;
2. be of outstanding character and distinction and have made substantial contributions to his/her field of endeavor or to society in general or;
3. be of outstanding character and distinction and have made significant contributions to the development of Southeastern or the State of Louisiana in education, the arts, public life, or some other appropriate field of endeavor.

iii. In the case of requests to name a Facility or Program in honor of an organization or corporation, the NAC will be guided by the following criteria:

1. be a Notable Donor or Benefactor to the university as defined herein;
2. have an honorable reputation;
3. agree in writing that the name recognition does not imply a marketing or product endorsement nor will the name recognition be so used by the corporation or organization, except in the case of advertising prescribed in connection with Southeastern Athletics, nor will the name recognition include the permanent installation of a company or organization logo or mark;
4. be named for a specified period of time as outlined in the naming or sponsorship agreement approved by the President and the Board of Supervisors in accordance with this Policy.

iv. University Facilities and Programs may be named to honor a living individual in accordance with State statutes. In order to avoid any appearance of a conflict of interest in such instances, current holders of elected public office, candidates for public office, current Southeastern employees and members of the ULS Board of Supervisors and of the Louisiana Board of Regents for Higher Education are not eligible for consideration.

v. Honorific naming should recognize distinguished service or achievement consistent with the University's mission and values. Proposals require extraordinary justification and must demonstrate that the naming will bring distinction and honor to the University.

III. **Duration and Modification of Naming**

A. Duration: The duration of a benefactor's name on any facility or unit should be defined in the naming or sponsorship agreement. Upon demolition, replacement, substantial renovation, re-designation of purpose, merger, change in nature or similar modification of a named facility or unit, the university may deem that the naming period has concluded.
   1. The appropriate university representative will make all reasonable efforts to inform in advance the original benefactors or their surviving family members when the naming period is deemed to have concluded.
   2. The university will provide for the appropriate perpetuation of the previous name. Perpetuation of the original name in an equivalent naming is not required. Appropriate perpetuation of previous names may include, for instance, a plaque in or adjacent to new and renovated facilities. In this way, the university will keep alive the memory of its supporters.
   3. In the event of name changes, the university may deem that the naming period has concluded.

B. Renaming: When the benefactor's naming period has concluded, the facility or unit may be renamed, with the original name removed, in recognition of new gifts, subject to any specific terms and conditions set forth in the original naming agreement.

C. Term Naming: In appropriate instances, most often involving a corporate benefactor, a naming may be granted for a pre-determined fixed term, usually ten years. At the end of the term, the name of the facility or unit shall expire but may be renewed with the same or a new name. The gift agreement should clearly specify the period of time for which the facility or unit will be named. All name recognition associated with sponsorships are to be for a set term.

D. Benefactor or Honoree Name Changes: If a benefactor requests a change to the name of a facility or unit, the university will consider the request. If approved, all replacement signage and other related costs may be at the donor’s expense.

E. Revocation of Naming Approval or Conferral: In certain circumstances, the university reserves the right, on reasonable grounds, to revoke and terminate its obligations regarding a naming with no financial responsibility for returning any received contributions to the benefactor.
   1. If the benefactor's reputation changes substantially so that the continued use of that name may compromise the public trust, dishonor the university's standards, or otherwise be contrary to the best interests of the university, the naming may be revoked. However, caution must be taken when, with the passage of time, the standards and achievements deemed to justify a naming action may change and observers of a later age may deem those who conferred a naming honor at an earlier age to have erred. Naming should not be altered simply because later observers would have made different judgments.
   2. If the benefactor fails to maintain payments on a pledge upon which the naming was bestowed, the naming may be revoked.
   3. If a planned gift upon which the naming was bestowed does not result in the value agreed upon, the naming may be revoked.

IV. **Administration of this Policy:**

The VPUA administers this policy, ensures its inclusion in all naming agreements, and oversees policy reviews, particularly prior to campaigns or major giving initiatives.

V. **Compliance with Policy:**

Compliance with this Policy is expected from all University administrators, faculty, staff, and students. Facilities managers shall not install any naming signage without confirmation from the Office of University Advancement. Non-compliance may harm donor relationships and fundraising efforts. Questions should be directed to the Office of University Advancement.

VI. Governing Sources

A. Louisiana Revised Statute 42:267: Except as authorized or provided by law, no public building, public bridge, public park, [and certain other enumerated facilities] owned by the State or by any political subdivision of the

State, or by any institution receiving its support in whole or in part from the state shall be named in honor of any living person.

B. Louisiana Revised Statute 17:3351G: Each [higher education management] board may name buildings at institutions under its supervision and management in honor of living persons pursuant to a policy adopted by the board applicable to such actions. Such policy may include criteria to be used for the naming of buildings in honor of living persons, the policy shall require that such donation by made to an alumni association or a foundation that raises private funds for the support of the institution as provided in R.S. 17:3390.
C. University of Louisiana System Board Rule Chapter 6, Facilities Planning, Section V. Naming University Facilities: Facilities on campuses within the University of Louisiana System are named upon the recommendation of the institution president, with the approval and authority of the Board of Supervisors, in accordance with applicable statutes. … a building or portion of a building may be named to honor a living individual. In order to avoid any appearance of a conflict of interest in such instances, current holders of elected public office, candidates for public office, and current members of the Board of Supervisors for the University of Louisiana System are not eligible for consideration.

[End of Policy]